

m10ASYS ASCOM Driver

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Introduction

ASCOM dome/roof driver for observatories using the ELK M1 Gold and m1OASYS architecture.

Overview

Introduction

Welcome to m1OASYS

m1OASYS is an ASCOM-compliant observatory roof driver designed specifically for observatories controlled by an Elk M1 Gold security and automation system. The driver provides a reliable interface between ASCOM-compatible astronomy applications and the observatory roof, allowing automated roof operation while maintaining multiple layers of operational safety.

The driver supports roll-off roofs, clam-shell roofs, and other observatory enclosures that can be controlled through Elk M1 outputs and monitored through Elk M1 zones. By leveraging the Elk M1's proven reliability and extensive I/O capabilities, m1OASYS provides a robust observatory automation solution suitable for both attended and unattended operation.

Key Features

ASCOM Dome Interface

m1OASYS implements the ASCOM Dome interface, allowing compatibility with a wide range of astronomy applications including:

- NINA
- Voyager
- ACP
- TheSkyX
- Sequence Generator Pro
- ASCOM Remote / Alpaca
- Other ASCOM-compliant software

Roof Control

The driver supports:

- Open roof commands
- Close roof commands
- Abort roof movement
- Roof status reporting
- Open and closed limit monitoring

Mount Safety Integration

Optional mount safety monitoring prevents unsafe roof movement when a telescope is not in a known safe position.

Features include:

- Safe-to-open verification

- Safe-to-close verification
- Continuous safety monitoring
- Configurable enable/disable operation

Pulse Telemetry

For installations equipped with a pulse or hall-effect sensor, m1OASYS can provide advanced roof position tracking.

Features include:

- Real-time pulse counting
- Roof percentage open calculation
- Automatic calibration
- Motion verification
- Position reporting

Motion Verification

Optional motion verification enhances operational safety by confirming that roof movement is actually occurring after a movement command is issued.

Features include:

- Motion timeout detection
- Stalled roof detection
- Fault reporting
- Automatic safety shutdown

Fault Detection and Recovery

m1OASYS continuously monitors roof operation and can detect a variety of abnormal conditions.

Examples include:

- Motion timeout faults
- Communication failures
- Safety violations
- Position inconsistencies

The driver maintains detailed fault information and provides diagnostic information through the Status Window.

Real-Time Status Window

An integrated status window provides live telemetry and operational information.

Displayed information includes:

- Roof state
- Percent open
- Pulse count
- Mount safety status
- Fault status
- Last fault time
- Reconnect history

- Watchdog activity

Multi-Controller Support

Current versions support multiple controller architectures including:

- Single-button motor controllers
- Dedicated Open/Close controllers
- Dedicated Open/Close/Stop controllers

This allows the driver to interface with a wide variety of commercial and custom roof control systems.

ASCOM Remote and Alpaca Compatibility

m1OASYS can be used through ASCOM Remote Server, making the observatory available over an Alpaca network connection.

This allows remote control from compatible Alpaca clients while preserving the full functionality of the native ASCOM driver.

Design Goals

m1OASYS was designed with the following objectives:

- Reliability
- Safety
- Simplicity
- Compatibility
- Fault tolerance
- Observatory automation

The driver emphasizes predictable operation and safe recovery from abnormal conditions while remaining easy to configure and maintain.

Intended Audience

This documentation is intended for:

- Observatory owners
- Astrophotographers
- Remote observatory operators
- Observatory system integrators
- ASCOM software users
- Elk M1 automation users

Whether operating a backyard roll-off roof observatory or a fully automated remote installation, m1OASYS provides a flexible and reliable roof automation platform integrated with the ASCOM ecosystem.

No warranty as to the operation or automation of the observatory equipment; it simply provides components for 'Do It Yourself' automation projects.

Caution! Automation of any rolling roof observatory requires special attention with regard to the location of individuals in the observatory, as well as the position of the telescope/mount, prior to moving the roof to ensure no one or nothing obstructs the roofs path. Serious injury to individuals and/or damage to telescope, mount or the observatory may occur if this advice is not followed. We recommend that all users of m1 ASCOM driverLive implement safety policies and procedures regarding the operation of their rolling roof. In addition we strongly recommend installation of safety sensors that will prevent or stop movement of the roof should individuals or equipment move into an unsafe position before or during roof movement. For remote/automated operation of rolling roofs it is recommended that the “*Allow Remote Apps to Open/Close the Roof*” check-box in the m1 ASCOM driverLive Live software be unchecked if the roof does not safely clear the scopes/mounts. Misuse or careless operation can cause serious damage to your equipment or individuals. The author of the software and the distributor of the equipment (1) make no warranty or representation to the user as to the operation of this System and (2) is NOT responsible for any injury or damage that may occur from careless implementation, operation or misuse. **Opening or Closing a roll-off roof is not a trivial task and the operator needs to take all necessary precautions before starting the roof motor. Damage to equipment or persons can occur when the roof is in motion so all necessary precautions should be taken before executing such a command.**

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System Requirements

Hardware Requirements

- Windows PC
- ASCOM Platform
- ELK M1 Gold with XEP Ethernet interface
- Configured ElkRP automation rules
- Optional Hall-effect pulse sensor
- Optional scope-safe sensors
-

Driver Architecture

Component	Responsibility
ELK M1	Hardware authority and sensor evaluation
ASCOM Driver	Roof control, telemetry, safety enforcement
Client Software	Observatory sequencing and telescope control

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Elk m1 Rules, Texts, Counters, Etc.

ELK M1 Configuration

Overview

The m1OASYS ASCOM Roof Driver communicates directly with the ELK M1/XEP using Elk ASCII text commands over TCP/IP.

The ELK provides:

- Hardware relay control
- Roof position sensing
- Optional Hall pulse telemetry
- Optional scope-safe interlock evaluation
- Status responses back to the ASCOM driver

The ASCOM driver is responsible for:

- Roof automation
- Telemetry interpretation
- Safety enforcement
- Calibration
- Watchdog protection
- ASCOM interoperability

Required ELK Configuration

Required Tasks

The following ELK tasks are expected by the driver.

Task	Purpose
Task 1	Open Roof
Task 2	Close Roof
Task 3	Stop Roof
Example names:	
Task Number	Suggested Name
1	Open Roof
2	Close Roof
3	Stop Roof

Required Zones

Roof Open Limit

Zone	Purpose
Zone 11	Roof Opened Sensor
Expected behavior:	
• SECURE = Roof fully open	

Roof Closed Limit

Zone	Purpose
Zone 12	Roof Closed Sensor
Expected behavior:	
• SECURE = Roof fully closed	

Optional Zones

Scope Safety Sensor

Zone	Purpose
Zone 7	Scope Safe Sensor
Expected behavior:	
• SECURE = Telescope safe for roof motion • NOT SECURE = Unsafe for roof motion	
This zone is only required if:	
• "Enable Mount Safety Sensors" is enabled in the ASCOM Setup Dialog.	

Hall Pulse Sensor

Zone	Purpose
Zone 5	Roof Motion Pulse Sensor
Used for:	
• pulse counting • calibration • percent-open tracking • watchdog protection	
This zone is optional.	

Required Counters

Roof Pulse Counter

Counter	Purpose
Counter 7	Roof motion pulse count
The driver polls this counter during motion when pulse telemetry is enabled.	

Required Text Definitions

Open Roof Command

Text Number	Value
2	09tn00100C4^M

Close Roof Command

Text Number	Value
3	09tn00200C3^M

Roof Status Query

Text Number	Value
7	09xx00100B6^M

Scope Safety Query

	Text Number	Value
	20	11xx005sensoron0042^M

Pulse Counter Query

	Text Number	Value
	25	07cv00729^M

Required Driver Responses

Roof Open Response

ELK sends:

0DXX001open0039^M

Driver interprets:

- roof fully open
-

Roof Closed Response

ELK sends:

0FXX001closed006F^M

Driver interprets:

- roof fully closed
-

Roof Unknown Response

ELK sends:

10XX001unknown00EE^M

Driver interprets:

- roof moving / intermediate state
-

Scope Safety Responses

Scope Safe

ELK sends:

0FXX002Secure0081^M

Driver interprets:

- roof motion allowed
-

Scope Unsafe

ELK sends:

12XX002NotSecure0063^M

Driver interprets:

- roof motion blocked
-

Required Automation Rules

Open Roof Task

WHENEVER Open Roof (Task 1) IS ACTIVATED
THEN TURN Open Roof Relay ON

Close Roof Task

WHENEVER Close Roof (Task 2) IS ACTIVATED
THEN TURN Close Roof Relay ON

Stop Roof Task

WHENEVER Stop Roof (Task 3) IS ACTIVATED
THEN TURN Open Roof Relay OFF
THEN TURN Close Roof Relay OFF

Roof Status Query Rules

The driver periodically requests roof status using:

09xx00100B6^M

ELK must respond with:

- OPEN
- CLOSED
- or UNKNOWN

based on current limit switch state.

Pulse Counting Rule

WHENEVER Roof Pulse Zone BECOMES NOT SECURE
THEN ADD 1 TO Counter 7

Pulse Counter Reset Rules

WHENEVER Open Roof Task ACTIVATES
THEN SET Counter 7 TO 0
WHENEVER Roof Closed Sensor BECOMES SECURE
THEN SET Counter 7 TO 0

Scope Safety Rules

WHENEVER THE FOLLOWING TEXT IS RECEIVED:
11xx005sensoron0042^M

AND Scope Safe Zone IS SECURE

THEN SEND:

0FXX002Secure0081^M

WHENEVER THE FOLLOWING TEXT IS RECEIVED:

11xx005sensoron0042^M

AND Scope Safe Zone IS NOT SECURE

THEN SEND:

12XX002NotSecure0063^M

Notes

CRC Framing

The driver internally generates CRC-framed Elk packets automatically.

ELK rules must match the fully framed transmitted text including:

- packet length
 - CRC
 - carriage return (^M)
-

Optional Features

The following driver features are optional:

Feature	Required Hardware
Pulse Telemetry	Hall sensor
Percent Open Tracking	Hall sensor
Scope Safety Interlock	Scope-safe sensor

The driver supports traditional limit-switch-only operation when optional hardware is not installed.

Recommended Architecture

ELK Responsibilities

- Relay control
- Sensor authority
- Pulse counting
- Safety state determination

ASCOM Driver Responsibilities

- Roof automation
- Telemetry processing
- Calibration
- Watchdog protection
- Safety enforcement

Client Software Responsibilities

- Observatory sequencing
- Telescope parking
- Imaging automation

This separation provides a reliable and maintainable observatory control system.

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Optional

Installation

m1 ASCOM driver is available via Internet download.

Important: m1 ASCOM driver requires the installation of the ASCOM Platform, available at <http://ascom-standards.org>.

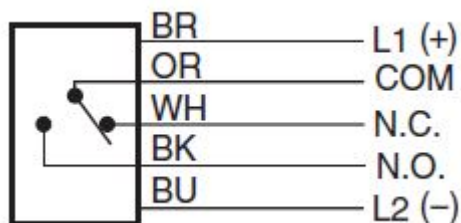
Internet Installation

1. Download the latest m1 ASCOM driver driver and software.
2. You will be prompted to either 'Run' the installer or you can save it to a folder; double clicked the saved file with start the installer.
3. Follow the on screen instructions to complete the installation.
4. Once the software has successfully installed you must enter the setup areas to input the proper setting before attempting to connect your hardware.

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Scope Position Sensor

Eaton 1451E



Supply power to the sensor via the m1 ASCOM driver board's +12v (brown) and -12v (Blue), then connected the common (Orange) and normally open (N.O. Black) sensor wires to the appropriate zone input.

Create rules to ensure the sensor is secure before moving the roof, and you can even wire the power through a m1 ASCOM driver output relays to give you control of turning the IR beam on and off before and after opening and closing commands are sent.

Rule examples:

WHENEVER THE FOLLOWING TEXT IS RECEIVED: "11xx005sensoron0042^M" THROUGH PORT 0
THEN TURN Scope IR Sen (Out 13) ON

WHENEVER Open Roof (Task 1) IS ACTIVATED
AND Scope 1 Sensor 1 (Zn 7) IS SECURE
THEN TURN Open Roof (Out 9) ON FOR 5 SECS

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Setup

Setup Configuration

1. Install the ASCOM Platform.
2. Install and register the m1OASYS ASCOM Roof Driver.
3. Configure the ELK M1 XEP IP address and port in the Setup Dialog.
4. Enable optional pulse telemetry if a Hall sensor is installed.
5. Enable optional scope safety interlock if safety sensors are installed.
6. Verify ElkRP text and automation rules are configured properly.
7. Connect the driver from NINA or another ASCOM client.

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Connection methods

Connection Methods

The m1OASYS driver supports two communication methods:

TCP/IP (Elk XEP)

Connects through the Elk XEP Ethernet interface.

Serial

Connects directly to the Elk M1 RS-232 port at 115200 baud.

Both connection methods use the native Elk ASCII protocol and provide identical functionality including:

- Roof control
- Pulse telemetry
- Calibration
- Scope safety
- Watchdog protection
- Live status monitoring

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Roof Motion Sensor

Roof Motion Verification

Hall Sensor Motion Monitoring

An optional Hall-effect sensor may be installed to verify that the roof is physically moving while an Open or

Close command is active.

Unlike traditional pulse-counting systems, m1OASYS does not use Hall sensor pulses to determine roof position. Roof position is determined exclusively by the Open and Closed limit switches.

The Hall sensor is used only to confirm roof movement.

Motion Verification

When a roof movement command is issued:

- The driver begins monitoring Hall sensor activity.
- Each detected pulse confirms that the roof is moving.
- If Hall sensor activity stops unexpectedly while movement is commanded, the driver assumes the roof has stalled or a mechanical failure has occurred.
- A fault condition is generated and reported to ASCOM clients.

This provides protection against:

- Motor failures
- Slipping drive mechanisms
- Broken chains or belts
- Mechanical obstructions
- Relay failures
- Roof stalls

Watchdog Protection

A configurable watchdog timer continuously verifies Hall sensor activity during roof motion.

If no Hall pulses are detected within the watchdog interval while the roof is commanded to move, the driver:

- Stops monitoring movement
- Enters a fault state
- Reports the condition to connected automation software

Position Determination

Roof position is determined solely by the limit switches:

- Open limit active = Roof Open
- Closed limit active = Roof Closed

Because physical limit switches provide absolute position information, no pulse calibration is required and no position drift can occur.

This design improves reliability and simplifies operation while maintaining robust motion verification.

Hardware Requirements

Required components:

- Hall Effect sensor
- Magnet mounted to roof drive gear, wheel, or shaft
- Elk M1 zone input
- Elk M1 counter

Each time the magnet passes the Hall sensor, a pulse is generated.

Elk M1 Zone Configuration

The Hall sensor should be connected to an unused Elk M1 zone.

Example:

Zone 5 = Roof Pulse Sensor

Recommended Elk configuration:

	Setting	Value
Definition		16 - Non Alarm
Area		1
Type		Normally Open or Normally Closed (depending on sensor wiring)
Description		Roof Pulse

The zone is used strictly for pulse counting and should not generate alarm conditions.

Elk Counter Configuration

Create an Elk counter to store accumulated roof pulses.

Example:

Counter 7 = Roof Pulse Count

The driver requests the current counter value and uses it as the live pulse count.

Elk Rule Configuration

Create a rule that increments the pulse counter whenever the Hall sensor changes state.

Example:

Whenever Zone 5 Becomes Not Secure

Then Increment Counter 7

Depending on the Hall sensor wiring and pulse frequency, either Secure or Not Secure transitions may be used.

Verify that the counter increases as the roof moves.

Driver Configuration

Enable pulse telemetry in the m1OASYS Setup Dialog.

Configuration options include:

- Enable Pulse Telemetry
- Open Pulse Count
- Motion Verification

The Open Pulse Count represents the number of pulses required for a complete roof travel from fully closed to fully open.

Pushover Notifications

Pushover Notifications

m1OASYS can send real-time notifications to a mobile device using the Pushover notification service. Notifications are delivered directly from the driver and can be customized to report only the events that are important to the user.

Requirements

To use Pushover notifications:

1. Create a Pushover account at <https://pushover.net>.
2. Create a new Pushover application (for example, "m1OASYS").
3. Copy the application's **API Token/Key**.
4. Copy your personal **User Key** from the Pushover dashboard.
5. Open the m1OASYS Setup dialog.
6. Enable **Pushover Notifications**.
7. Enter the Application Token and User Key.
8. Use the **Test Notification** button to verify operation.

Notification Settings

Individual notification types can be enabled or disabled using the Setup dialog.

Available notification categories include:

- Roof Opened
- Roof Closed
- Roof Fault
- Communication Lost
- Communication Restored
- Scope Unsafe Blocked Movement

Roof Opened

Sent when the observatory roof reaches the fully open position.

Example:

☐☐☐ Observatory roof opened

Roof Closed

Sent when the observatory roof reaches the fully closed position.

Example:

☐☐☐ Observatory roof closed

Roof Fault

Sent when a roof fault condition is detected.

Examples:

☐☐☐ Roof fault: No pulse movement

☐☐☐ Roof fault: Movement timeout

Scope Unsafe Blocked Movement

Sent when m1OASYS prevents roof movement because the telescope is not in a safe position.

Example:

☐Roof movement blocked - telescope not safe

Communication Lost

Sent when m1OASYS detects loss of communication with the ELK M1 controller.

Example:

☐ELK communication lost

Communication Restored

Sent when communication with the ELK M1 controller is restored.

Example:

☐ELK communication restored

Notes

- Notification settings are stored in the ASCOM Profile and persist between sessions.
- Each user supplies their own Pushover Application Token and User Key.
- Credentials are not included with the driver and are not stored in source code repositories.
- Notifications can be enabled individually to reduce unnecessary alerts.
- Communication monitoring uses telemetry activity to detect communication failures, including cases where the network connection remains open but valid controller responses stop.

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Using USR TCP/IP to Serial

Using a USR-TCP232-302 TCP/IP Serial Device Server with an ELK M1

m1OASYS supports communication with an ELK M1 through a USR-TCP232-302 serial-to-Ethernet device server. This allows the ELK panel to be accessed over a local network using either a TCP/IP connection or a Virtual COM Port (VCOM).

Recommended USR Configuration

Configure the USR-TCP232-302 as follows:

- Work Mode: TCP Server
- Local Port: 2102 (or another unused port)
- Baud Rate: 9600
- Data Bits: 8
- Parity: None
- Stop Bits: 1
- RFC2217: Disabled
- Short Connection: Disabled
- Link: Enabled
- Packing Time: 0
- Packing Length: 0

After saving the configuration, reboot the USR if necessary.

Virtual COM Port Configuration

If using the USR VCOM utility:

- Configure the VCOM connection as a TCP Client.
- Enter the IP address of the USR device.
- Use the same TCP port configured in the USR (2102 by default).
- Create a virtual COM port and verify that the VCOM status indicates "Connected."

Important Cable Requirement

The ELK M1 Port 0 serial connector and the USR-TCP232-302 serial connector are both wired as DCE devices. A standard straight-through serial cable will not allow communication between them.

A null modem adapter or null modem cable must be used between the ELK and the USR.

Minimum required wiring:

- Pin 2 ↔ Pin 3
- Pin 3 ↔ Pin 2
- Pin 5 ↔ Pin 5

If communication problems are encountered, verify the null modem adapter with a continuity meter. Some adapters are incorrectly wired or defective.

Verifying Communication

Before troubleshooting m1OASYS, verify communication independently:

1. Connect the ELK M1 to the USR using a null modem adapter.
2. Start the USR VCOM utility and connect to the device.
3. Open a terminal program such as PuTTY on the assigned virtual COM port.
4. Observe incoming ELK messages.

Typical unsolicited ELK messages include:

- XK messages (time and date updates)
- KC messages (counter/status updates)

Example:

```
16XK29141041006261100070
```

```
19KC01000000000333333300FF
```

If these messages are visible in the terminal program, the ELK, cabling, USR device, and VCOM configuration are operating correctly.

Connection Verification in m1OASYS

m1OASYS does not consider the ELK connected merely because a COM port or TCP socket opens successfully. The driver waits for valid ELK traffic before reporting a successful connection.

A connection is considered established when a valid ELK message such as VN, XK, KC, XX, or D6Z is received from the panel.

This prevents false-positive connections caused by incorrect COM port selections, disconnected cables, or inactive serial servers.

Features

Features

- ASCOM Dome interface support
- Open / Close / Abort roof control
- Live shutter state telemetry
- ELK M1 TCP/IP integration
- Optional Hall-effect pulse telemetry
- Automatic roof calibration
- Percent-open roof tracking
- Movement timeout watchdog
- Pulse watchdog protection
- Optional scope-safe interlock support
- Persistent calibration storage
- Integrated live telemetry status window

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Supported Software

Supported Applications

- NINA
- Voyager
- Sequence Generator Pro (SGP)
- CCD Commander
- Other ASCOM automation software

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Hardware Required

Hardware Requirements

- Windows PC
- ASCOM Platform
- ELK M1 Gold with XEP Ethernet interface
- Configured ElkRP automation rules
- Optional Hall-effect pulse sensor
- Optional scope-safe sensors

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Safety Features

Safety Features

Movement Timeout Watchdog

Detects stalled motion, failed relays, missing limit transitions, or roof jams. Automatically aborts motion and reports a fault state.

Pulse Watchdog Protection

When pulse telemetry is enabled, the driver monitors Hall pulses during roof movement. If motion pulses stop unexpectedly, the driver enters a fault state.

Scope Safety Interlock

Optional hardware-based scope-safe interlocks can be enabled through ELK rules. When enabled, the driver blocks roof movement unless the ELK reports the telescope is in a safe position.

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